



CIVITAS indicators

Pay disparity of public transport workers (SOC_EQ_WC3)

DOMAIN

				
Transport	Environment	Energy	Society	Economy

TOPIC

Equity

IMPACT

Working conditions in the transport sector
Improving working conditions in the transport sector

SOC_EQ

Category

Key indicator	Supplementary indicator	State indicator
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CONTEXT AND RELEVANCE

Mobility of individuals and transport of goods play a central role in the functioning of modern societies and economies. The delivery of transport services depends on the work of a vast number of individuals employed in driving, maintenance, logistics, and operations. These workers ensure that people and goods move reliably across territories. However, while transport enables essential economic and social activities, the working conditions in the sector often reflect significant challenges, including long or irregular working hours, physical and psychological stress, and relatively low wages compared to other sectors. Such conditions can lead to fatigue, safety risks, and reduced job satisfaction, ultimately affecting both workers' well-being and the quality of transport services. An informed understanding of employment conditions in the transport sector of the experiment city is essential to promote fair labor practices and safeguard the equitable and reliable provision of transport services.

This indicator provides a measure of the quality of working conditions in the transport sector. **It is relevant when the policy aims at promoting fair employment and sustainable economic conditions by improving the compensation of public transport workers in the experiment city relative to the average local salary. A successful action is reflected in a HIGHER value of the indicator.**

DESCRIPTION

This indicator is the ratio of the average wage of public transport workers in the experiment city to the overall average wage of workers in the experiment city across all sectors. Being a ratio, the indicator is dimensionless.

METHOD OF CALCULATION AND INPUTS

The indicator should be computed exogenously, by applying the method described and then coded in the supporting tool.

Method		
Calculation of the indicator based on data from transport operators and/or unions	Significance: 0.75	
INPUTS The following information is needed to compute the indicator: a) The average yearly wage of public transport workers in the experiment city. b) The average yearly wage of workers in the experiment city across all sectors. The experiment would result in the modification of the wages in the transport sector.		

METHOD OF CALCULATION

The indicator is computed according to the following steps:

- **Retrieval of the average net full-time equivalent salary of public transport workers in the experiment city.**

Methodological notes on data sourcing:

- Definition of public transport workers: includes all individuals directly employed in the operation, maintenance, or dispatch of urban and interurban transport services, such as drivers, vehicle maintenance personnel, and operational support staff. Exclude purely administrative personnel not directly involved in service provision. Exclude national or international transport services (e.g., long-distance rail and buses, flights).
 - Possible data sources are the public transport operators active in the experiment city or the labour unions representing transport workers. Regardless of the chosen source, two data collection approaches are possible: a) a census of all public transport workers; or b) a representative sample. In the latter case, ensure representativeness across relevant dimensions (e.g., public transport operator or union, job category, contract type).
 - If needed, convert gross wages to net wages according to relevant local regulation.
 - Scale part-time wages to full-time equivalents, then compute the average wage (see equations below).
- **Retrieval of the average net full-time equivalent salary of workers across all sectors in the experiment city.**
 - This data can be sourced from national statistical offices, municipal or regional labour market reports, or [Eurostat](#).
 - **Estimation of the indicator** (see equation below).

EQUATIONS

Scale wages to full-time equivalents and compute the average full-time wage according to the following equation:

$$TrSl = \frac{\sum_w (\frac{s_w}{h_w} * H)}{W}$$

Where:

s_w = Yearly salary of public transport worker w

h_w = Contract weekly work hours of public transport worker w

H = Full-time weekly work hours of public transport workers according to local regulation

W = Total number of surveyed public transport workers

The indicator should be computed using the following equation:

$$TrSlRt = \frac{TrSl}{AllSl}$$

Where:

TrSl = Average net full-time equivalent salary of public transport workers in the experiment city.

AllSl = Average net full-time equivalent salary of workers across all sectors in the experiment city.

ALTERNATIVE INDICATORS

This indicator measures the ratio of the average wage of public transport workers to the average income in the experiment city. Alternative indicators for assessing the fairness of working conditions in the transport sector include **SOC_EQ_WC1**, **SOC_EQ_WC2**, and **SOC_EQ_WC4**.

SOC_EQ_WC4 tracks the ratio of the average wage of logistics workers to the average income in the experiment city. **SOC_EQ_WC1** and **SOC_EQ_WC2** measure the share of public transport workers and logistics workers, respectively, who worked overtime at least once during the reference month in the experiment city.